

HOLLY AMBLER

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SENIOR UX RESEARCHER | MIXED METHODS RESEARCH

Passionate mixed-methods practitioner focusing on deep qualitative insights and jobs-to-be-done. Proven ability to uncover the questions behind the questions, define a plan in the face of ambiguity, choose the right method, and deliver clear, actionable insights that balance customer and business needs. Skilled at stakeholder management, both generative and evaluative research methods, a myriad of established and emerging tools, and communicating what matters.

EXPERTISE AND SKILLS

Mixed-Methods Research | Generative Research | Evaluative Research

Contextual Inquiry | Usability Benchmarking | Diary Studies | Single Ease Question | Surveys | Usability Testing | A/B Testing | Customer Journey Mapping | Requirements Gathering | Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) | Unmoderated Studies | Concept Testing | Cognitive Walkthroughs | Screener Development | Heuristic Evaluation | Accessibility Testing | Funnel Analysis | SWOT Analysis | Project Management | Wireframing | Information Architecture | Responsible AI | SharePoint | FigJam | Marvin | Copilot | Claude | Lovable | Microsoft Office Suite | Confluence/Jira

EXPERIENCE

MICROSOFT, Redmond, WA

January 2018 - July 2026

Senior UX Researcher

Supported entire Intune PM org, conducting generative and evaluative research on new features, benchmarking quality, and continuously improving overall product usability through actionable insights.

- Dedicated UX Researcher for Microsoft Intune for over 8 years and 50+ projects, performing end-to-end generative and evaluative research, from project inception through to post-launch telemetry tracking.
- Performed generative and evaluative research on AI in Intune, illuminating adoption blockers and opportunities that helped the product team define product behaviors, goals, and patterns in a rapidly changing and ambiguous environment.
- Surfaced deep qualitative insight on user behavior, motivations, and pain points that informed the product roadmap and major design decisions for the workloads and features throughout the product.
- Conducted generative research identifying AI opportunities across the product, informing feature direction and prioritization.
- Ran mixed-methods investigations into admin context-switching across management portals, surfacing friction points that shaped core device-management workflow improvements.
- Led a major overhaul of Intune's information architecture through multiple rounds of terminology studies, card sorts, and tree tests, shortening journey depth and improving findability and comprehension.
- Over three years, ran numerous rapid usability studies evaluating Copilot discoverability, usability, and fitness for purpose within Intune, guiding design coherence, funnel analysis, and responsible AI integration decisions.

EMC / DELL (ISILON), Greater Seattle Area

January 2013 - January 2018

Principal User Experience Researcher (Dual Role)

- Established and led the UX practice at Isilon, working with executive leadership to found a design, front-end engineering, and research pillar.
- Built widely adopted personas, introduced usability testing, standardized design language and artifacts, and socialized human-centered design.

- Partnered with teams across the organization to define user-centric interactions and workflows for the OneFS operating system and its companion product, InsightIQ.
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative research into user needs, translating findings into UX writing, design recommendations, and product decisions.

Senior Content Developer (Dual Role) - EMC / Dell (Isilon), January 2014 - December 2014

- Researched, designed, and maintained 23 internal troubleshooting guides; awarded the Isilon Cluster Award (2014).
- Authored EMC Technical Advisories, coordinating a multiphase review process with Isilon Executive Management and EMC Legal.
- Wrote patch READMEs and knowledge base articles, ensuring timely, actionable, and technically accurate documentation.
- Conducted extensive user research and developed personas that were widely adopted across product teams.
- Designed test plans, moderated user tests, and authored usability reports and field studies for high-visibility projects.
- Co-founded the ID-Strategy team, a UX specialist group reporting directly to the department Director. The team pioneered usability measurement at Isilon by designing and running terminology studies to measure user comprehension and information architecture efficacy.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

JPMC

Communications Lead

- **Communications Lead - JPMC:** Designed communication strategy and authored technical documentation and information architecture for a 175-person application development, hosting, and QA/QC organization.

JPMC / WAMU

Technical Writer and Editor

- **Technical Writer and Editor - JPMC / WaMu:** Authored technical documentation, brochures, and training materials across application development, cloud architecture, security, and technology governance teams.

EDUCATION

MS, Human Centered Design and Engineering
University of Washington

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior UX Researcher specializing in generative and evaluative mixed-methods research across enterprise cloud, security, and endpoint management products. Deep expertise in Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) frameworks and AI/Copilot usability research, translating qualitative insight into product strategy and roadmap decisions. MS in Human Centered Design and Engineering. BS in Anthropology. Certificate in Technical Communication from University of Washington.